

EYEWITNESS May 1972

Besieged at An Loc

To those besieged at An Loc, the NVA's shelling felt endless, as the bombardment turned their city to rubble. Captain Harold Moffett Jr., who survived the barrage of more than 50,000 rounds of artillery, rockets, and mortars over one night, compared An Loc to Berlin after World War II. Lieutenant Colonel Ed Bedit also recorded the destructive transformation of the city.

Captain Harold Moffett Jr. describes how they counted the rounds as they came in to An Loc by the hour until they increased so much they could not keep up. It seemed almost impossible to put so many rounds into one small area in such a small period of time. The shelling annihilated well over 100 civilians, mostly women and children.

Lieutenant colonel Ed Bedit saw the intermittent shelling transform the once bustling, rural metropolitan area into a cemetery where nothing moved. All the people and livestock disappeared underground.

“ Every living creature, person, or animal had his own crawl space and would remain there for what would seem like an eternity.”

Lieutenant Colonel Ed Bedit, senior adviser in An Loc, quoted by Phil Clarke in *The Reader's Digest*, March 1973